



MOCK TEST: INDIAN ECONOMY ON THE EVE OF INDEPENDENCE

Class 12 – Indian Economic Development (NCERT Chapter 1)

PREPARED BY THUNDERSTUDY ✨

Time Allowed	1 Hour 30 Minutes
Maximum Marks	80 Marks
Composition	30 MCQs, 10 VSA, 5 SA, 3 LA

SECTION A – MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS (30 × 1 = 30 Marks)

1. Which of the following was NOT a feature of the Indian economy at the time of independence?

(A) Predominantly agrarian (B) High industrial growth rate (C) Inadequate infrastructure (D) Dependence on British exports

2. The share of agriculture in India's national income in 1947 was approximately:

(A) 20% (B) 35% (C) 50% (D) 70%

3. Which sector contributed the largest share to India's exports in the pre-independence period?

(A) Manufactured goods (B) Agricultural raw materials (C) Services (D) Minerals

4. The "Drain of Wealth" theory was associated with:

(A) Mahatma Gandhi (B) Dadabhai Naoroji (C) Jawaharlal Nehru (D) Sir William Jones

5. The principal cash crop grown in British India was:

(A) Wheat (B) Rice (C) Cotton (D) Sugarcane

6. Which of the following was a major problem of Indian agriculture on the eve of independence?

(A) Over-irrigation (B) Excessive use of fertilizers (C) Dependence on monsoons (D) Surplus of foodgrains

7. The industrial policy of the British aimed at:

(A) Promoting heavy industries (B) Developing a self-sufficient base (C) Making India a supplier of raw materials (D) Encouraging indigenous entrepreneurship

8. Which Indian industry suffered the most due to the import of cheap British goods?

(A) Textile industry (B) Steel industry (C) Cement industry (D) Jute industry

9. The 'Tata Iron and Steel Company' (TISCO) was set up in:

(A) 1907 (B) 1914 (C) 1925 (D) 1935

10. The population of India in 1947 was approximately:

(A) 250 million (B) 330 million (C) 400 million (D) 500 million

11. The literacy rate in India at the time of independence was around:

(A) 12% (B) 24% (C) 40% (D) 60%

12. Which was NOT a part of the colonial infrastructural development?

(A) Railways (B) Roads (C) Tele-communication (D) Large-scale irrigation projects

13. The primary reason for the slow growth of India's railway network after 1853 was:

(A) Lack of capital (B) Insufficient demand (C) Political instability (D) Opposition from merchants

14. The 'Indigo Revolt' was a protest by farmers against:

(A) Excessive taxation (B) Forced cultivation (C) Export restrictions (D) Price decline

15. The 'Permanent Settlement' was introduced in:

(A) Bengal (B) Madras (C) Bombay (D) Punjab

16. Under the 'Zamindari system', the primary role of the Zamindar was to:

(A) Cultivate land (B) Collect revenue for British (C) Provide credit (D) Manage irrigation

17. The term "Deindustrialisation" refers to:

(A) Growth of small industries (B) Decline of indigenous manufacturing (C) Expansion of mills
(D) Increased employment

18. British land revenue systems led to:

(A) Reduced debt (B) Security of tenure (C) Indebtedness due to revenue demands (D)
Elimination of middlemen

19. The 'Grow More Food' campaign was launched during:

(A) First 5-Year Plan (B) Second 5-Year Plan (C) British period (D) Green Revolution

20. High life expectancy was NOT a feature of:

(A) Pre-independence demographic profile (B) Developed nations (C) Modern India (D)
Urban populations

21. Which state had the highest tea plantation concentration?

(A) Assam (B) Darjeeling (C) Tamil Nadu (D) Karnataka

22. The 'Great Bengal Famine' occurred in:

(A) 1942-43 (B) 1945-46 (C) 1947-48 (D) 1950-51

23. The primary cause of the Great Bengal Famine was:

(A) Drought (B) Wartime policies and procurement failure (C) Floods (D) Over-production

24. The share of foreign trade with Britain was approximately:

(A) 30% (B) 50% (C) 70% (D) 90%

25. The Suez Canal (1869) reduced the cost of transport between:

(A) India and China (B) India and Britain (C) Britain and USA (D) India and Japan

26. Demographic profile of 1947 included:

(A) High life expectancy (B) Low infant mortality (C) Low life expectancy, high infant
mortality (D) Balanced sex ratio

27. The primary source of foreign exchange was:

(A) Export of manufactured goods (B) Export of raw materials (C) Tourism (D) Foreign aid

28. The 'Year of Great Divide' in Indian population history is:

(A) 1921 (B) 1947 (C) 1951 (D) 1911

29. The 'Nationalist' critique was articulated by:

(A) Gokhale (B) Tilak (C) Naoroji (D) All of the above

30. Condition of industrial labor in 1947:

(A) Strong unions (B) Formal sector jobs (C) Low wages and poor conditions (D) Service sector focus

SECTION B – VERY SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (10 × 2 = 20 Marks)

31. Mention two features of the Indian agricultural economy in 1947.
32. State two reasons for the slow growth of Indian industries under British rule.
33. What was “Drain of Wealth”? Who popularised this concept?
34. Name any two major infrastructure projects undertaken by the British.
35. Give two reasons for low literacy at independence.
36. Mention two consequences of the Zamindari system.
37. What was the main objective of British land-revenue policies?
38. Why did the export of Indian handicrafts decline?
39. Define “De-industrialisation” in the colonial context.
40. State two demographic indicators of the 1940s.

SECTION C – SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (5 × 4 = 20 Marks)

41. Analyse the impact of the Suez Canal on Indian foreign trade.
42. Discuss the stagnation of agriculture under the Zamindari system.
43. How did the colonial government’s economic policies affect the textile industry?
44. Examine the demographic profile of India on the eve of independence.
45. Explain the causes and effects of the Great Bengal Famine.

SECTION D – LONG ANSWER QUESTIONS (3 × 6 = 18 Marks)

46. Critically evaluate the state of Indian infrastructure on the eve of independence.
47. “Indian economy was a feeder economy for the British.” Justify this statement.
48. Discuss the factors responsible for the backwardness of the industrial sector in colonial India.

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